

ZACHARIAH EMMANUEL

Department of Economics
 Andrew Young School of Policy Studies
 Georgia State University
 Atlanta, GA 30302.

E-mail: zemmanuel2@gsu.edu
 Google Scholar: [\[Link\]](#)
 ORCID-ID NO: 0000-0001-9636-632X
 Web Site: zachariahemmanuel.com

EDUCATION	Georgia State University , Andrew Young School of Policy Studies	
	Ph.D. <i>Economics</i>	Expected 2027
	M.A. <i>Economics</i>	2024
	<i>Dissertation:</i> Essays on Health and Applied Development Economics <i>Committee:</i> James H. Marton (Chair), Lauren Hoehn-Velasco, Angela B. Snyder & David Wu	
	University of Ibadan	
	M.Sc. <i>Economics</i>	2018
	University of Jos	
	B.Sc. <i>Economics</i>	2012
ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS	Federal University Wukari	
	Associate Lecturer, Department of Economics	2020–2022
	Assistant Lecturer, Department of Economics	2018–2020
FIELDS	<i>Health Economics, Public Economics & Demographic Economics</i>	
JOB MARKET PAPER	“Exploring the Differential Impact of the Repeal of the ACA Individual Mandate by Health Status” <i>Abstract:</i> Health insurance mandates are designed to mitigate adverse selection by encouraging enrollment among relatively healthy individuals. Yet, little is known about how removing these incentives affects relatively healthy and sick consumers. This paper examines the differential impact of repealing the Affordable Care Act (ACA) individual mandate on insurance participation, Marketplace premiums, out-of-pocket premium spending, and consumer surplus. I exploit the 2019 repeal of the federal mandate penalty using a two-way fixed effects (TWFE) design that compares states without their own mandates to states that retained mandate policies. I find that the repeal increased the probability of becoming newly uninsured by 0.56 percentage points (approximately 27 percent relative to the pre-reform mean), with nearly all of the increase driven by relatively healthy consumers, while insurance participation among relatively sick consumers remained largely unchanged. Benchmark Marketplace premiums for a 27-year-old enrollee increased by approximately \$739, while average out-of-pocket premium spending decreased by \$284.60 because the ACA premium subsidies offset much of the increase in benchmark premiums. Translating these estimates into a consumer surplus framework reveals that, in the absence of premium subsidies, relatively sick consumers bear most of the losses in consumer surplus associated with adverse selection. However, accounting for the ACA premium subsidies substantially mitigates the financial burden. These findings demonstrate that ACA premium subsidies substantially alter the distributional consequences of adverse selection by limiting the pass-through of higher Marketplace premiums to consumers who remain insured.	

WORKING PAPER

“Does Tobacco 21 Minimum Legal Sales Age Policy improve Respiratory Health? Evidence from the United States” (with M.O. Emmanuel, G. Aipoh, V.J. Dickson, E.N. Collins). Revise & Resubmit at *Social Science & Medicine*

Abstract: Tobacco use remains a leading contributor to preventable respiratory morbidity, yet empirical evaluations of tobacco control policies have largely emphasized behavioral responses rather than measurable health outcomes. This study examines the short-term respiratory health implications of Tobacco-21 minimum legal sales age (MLSA) laws in the United States. In particular, we assess whether this tobacco restriction policy reduces the prevalence of asthma among late teenagers and young adults. Taking advantage of the staggered adoption of this law across states, we use a dataset from the Behavioral Risk Factor Surveillance System (BRFSS) from 2011 to 2019. We estimate the effects of the Tobacco 21 MLSA policy on smoking behavior and asthma prevalence among individuals aged 18–20. Consistent with prior research, we find that the Tobacco-21 MLSA policy is associated with significant reductions in smoking among young people. However, we find that this does not translate into a significant decline in asthma prevalence in the short run. Although our subgroup analyses suggest larger reductions in asthma prevalence among Black young adults and 19-year-olds, these estimates are statistically insignificant. In general, our estimates are small and imprecise, with confidence intervals that include both modest reduction and increase in asthma prevalence. The findings suggest that reductions in smoking behavior may not immediately translate into measurable improvements in respiratory health outcomes, potentially due to continued secondhand smoke exposure, implementation lags, increased diagnosis, and imperfect compliance with the law. The absence of this short-run change should not be interpreted as evidence of no health benefit. Instead, it underscores the importance of considering timing, exposure pathways, and outcome measurement when evaluating the health impacts of tobacco control policies.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

1. “Spillover effects of Prescription Drug Insurance on Informal Caregiving: Evidence from Social Security Disability Insurance (SSDI) Medicare Recipients”
2. “Do Non-Financial Incentives improve Maternal Health Outcomes? Evidence from the Nigeria’s Abiye (Safe Motherhood) Program”

PRE-DOCTORAL PUBLICATIONS

1. The Determinants of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises’ (MSMEs) Performance in Nigeria: Evidence from Business Enterprise Survey (with Rosemary A. Anga and Charity G. Isa). *Development Bank of Nigeria (DBN) Journal of Economics and Sustainable Growth* 3(1), Pages 21-45, 2020. [\[Link\]](#)
2. Public Debt Sustainability in Nigeria after the exit from Paris Club: The role of Structural Breaks (with Adewumi Otonne and Jane O. Asogwa). *Acta Universitatis Danubius (Economica) Journal*, 15(7) Pages 148-163, 2019. [\[Link\]](#)
3. Predicting Exchange Rate with Commodity Prices: New Evidence from Westerlund and Narayan (2015) Estimator with Structural Breaks and Asymmetries (with Afees A. Salisu, Wasiu Adekunle, and Wasiu A. Alimi). 2019. *Resources Policy* 62, March 2019, Pages 33-56. [\[Link\]](#)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Georgia State University

Research Assistant for Dr. Pierre Nguimkeu, Department of Economics	Summer 2026
Research Assistant for Dr. David Ribar, Georgia Policy Lab	Fall 2025
Research Assistant for Dr. Vjollca Sadiraj, Experimental Economics Lab	Fall 2025
Research Assistant for Dr. Lorenzo Almada, Department of Economics	Summer 2024
Research Assistant for Dr. Daniel Kreisman, Georgia Policy Lab	Fall 2023
Research Assistant for Dr. Amy Eremionkhale, Department of Economics	Summer 2023

Center for Econometrics & Applied Research (CEAR)

Research Assistant for Dr. Afees Salisu	2018–2019
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TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Instructor of Record, Georgia State University Data Science for Economists Course Evaluation: 4.9 / 5.0	Summer 2026 (12 students)
	Teaching Assistant, Georgia State University Econometrics II (PhD) Data Science for Economists (Undergraduate) Principles of Macroeconomics (Undergraduate) Applied Statistics (Masters) Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate)	Spring 2026 Spring 2025 Spring 2024 Spring 2024 Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2024
	Instructor of Record, Federal University Wukari Economic Planning (Undergraduate) Taxation & Fiscal Policy (Undergraduate) Advanced Macroeconomics II (Undergraduate) Intermediate Macroeconomics II (Undergraduate) Mathematics for Economists I (Undergraduate) Introduction to Microeconomics (Undergraduate)	Fall 2021 Spring 2021 Spring 2021 Spring 2020 Fall 2019, Spring 2022 Fall 2019, Spring 2021, Fall 2021
	Georgia State University Center for Economic Analysis of Risk (CEAR), Dissertation Fellowship APPAM Equity and Inclusion Fellowship E.D. Jack Dunn Fellowship and Research Award	2025–2026 2025 2024, 2025
ACADEMIC AWARD & FELLOWSHIPS	University of Ibadan Tertiary Education Trust (TET) Fund Fellowship Award	2017–2018
	University of Jos Tony Elumelu Foundation Prize for best graduating student in Economics Chevron Nigeria National University Merit Scholarship Award	2013 2009–2012
INVITED WORKSHOP(S) & CONFERENCE(S) (*Scheduled)	2026: Southern Economics Association (SEA) Conference, Houston, TX*; Association of Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Conference, Boston, MA*; Georgia State University PhD Summer Symposium, American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) Conference, Minneapolis, MN; EconNect Africa Seminar Series (Virtual); Georgia State University Graduate Research Conference, Atlanta, GA. 2025: Association of Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Conference, Seattle, WA; Realist Economic Evaluation Conference, Atlanta, GA; Atlanta Economics PhD Students Symposium, Emory University; American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) Conference, Nashville, TN; Empirical Methods in Social Science Research Workshop, Clemson University, SC; Georgia State University Graduate Research Conference Atlanta, GA.	
UNDERGRADUATE STUDENT SUPERVISION	Godwin E. Ekpe , “The Effects of Oil Price Volatility on Economic Growth in Nigeria” 2021 Blessing I. Samuel , “The Determinants of Public Healthcare Spending in Nigeria”, 2021 Mathias Rimamsanati , “Public Health Expenditure and Life Expectancy in Nigeria”, 2021	
UNIVERSITY SERVICE	Federal University Wukari Secretary , Economics Department Board Member , Undergraduate Project Topic Review Committee Economics Department Rep , University Quality Assurance Committee	2019–2022 2021–2022 2021–2022
SERVICE & LEADERSHIP	President , Graduate Christian Fellowship at Georgia State University Reviewer , ASHEcon Conference Abstracts Reviewer , Etinosa Oghogho Foundation Undergraduate Scholarship Judge , Georgia State Undergraduate Research Conference (GSURC)	2024- 2025–2026 2024–2025 2024–2025
PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP	<i>American Economics Association (AEA), Nigerian Economics Society (NES), Royal Economics Society (RES), American Society of Health Economist (ASHEcon), Association of Public Policy and Management (APPAM), Southern Economics Association (SEA).</i>	
REFEREE SERVICE	<i>SN Business & Economics (1x), Energy Research & Social Science (1x)</i>	

OTHER EMPLOYMENT	Financial Analyst , United Capital Plc, Lagos Island, Nigeria Economics Teacher , National Youth Service Corps (NYSC), Ibadan, Nigeria	2015–2015 2013–2014
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PROGRAMMING LANGUAGE	Microsoft Office, Stata, R-studio, LaTeX, Beamer
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REFERENCE	James H. Marton, Ph.D. Professor & Chair, Department of Economics, Andrew Young School of Policy Studies, Georgia State University, Atlanta, 30302 GA. marton@gsu.edu +1 (404) 413-0256 Angela B. Snyder, Ph.D. Professor & Director, Center of Excellence for Behavioral Health & Wellbeing, Department of Public Management & Policy, Georgia Health Policy Center, Andrew Young School of Policy Studies, Georgia State University, Atlanta, 30302 GA. angiesnyder@gsu.edu +1 (404) 413-0285	Lauren Hoehn-Velasco Ph.D. Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, Andrew Young School of Policy Studies, Georgia State University, Atlanta, 30302 GA. lvelasco@gsu.edu +1 (404) 413-0259 David Q. Wu Ph.D. Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, Andrew Young School of Policy Studies, Georgia State University, Atlanta, 30302 GA. qwu12@gsu.edu +1 (404) 413-0150
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